LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across logistics, payments and retail. Experienced with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Snowflake, AWS and large-scale batch and streaming pipelines. Strong background in dimensional data modeling, data quality, data contracts, warehouse and transformation performance optimization, and platform reliability, with a focus on reusable, well-tested solutions. Contributes to open-source projects and shares data engineering practices through mentoring and community teaching.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace) | 03/2022 - present

- Own the ingestion and orchestration layer of the data platform, operating approximately 140 Airflow DAGs that load data from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated 300+ stored procedures to 420+ dbt models, using incremental models and performance-focused transformation design; reduced nightly warehouse build time from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Improved Snowflake warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and unused-table management, reducing monthly Snowflake spend from approximately 38k to 24k in 2024.
- Designed and built a Kafka-based shipment event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing approximately 30 million events daily with p95 end-to-end latency under two minutes.
- Added dead-letter handling and replay tooling to enable failed events to be reprocessed without data loss.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium change data capture into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 per month to 2 per month.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation; mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup) | 09/2019 - 02/2022

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw S3 files daily.
- Reduced finance team's manual reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.
- Designed a Redshift dimensional warehouse schema with 30+ fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Introduced Great Expectations data quality checks on critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, used by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group | 06/2017 - 08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL processes for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron, making data loads easier to debug and change.
- Built Power BI reports supporting store operations across 40+ stores.

OPEN-SOURCE AND COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest, Airflow, 2023).
- Presented "Data contracts without the hype" at a regional data meetup (2024).
- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University | 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate | May 2024

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data engineering: Airflow, dbt, PySpark, Spark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Great Expectations
Warehousing and databases: Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server
Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic)
CI/CD and testing: GitHub Actions, JSON Schema, pytest
Data modeling and platform practices: Dimensional modeling, data contracts, data quality, change data capture (CDC), batch and streaming pipelines
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (C1) | German (B1)